Writing an article (1)

DISCUSS THE TOPIC

- How do you decide where to go on holiday?
- Do articles about places help you decide where to go on holiday? Why/Why not?

SAMPLE WRITING

Read the rubric and the sample article. The first sentence of each paragraph in the main part is missing. Read the sentences a-e below and choose three of them to fill in the missing sentences in the article.

An English-speaking travel magazine has asked its readers to write an article on the topic:

An interesting place to visit.

Write a short article for this magazine. (120-180 words)

VICTORIA FALLS NATIONAL PARK

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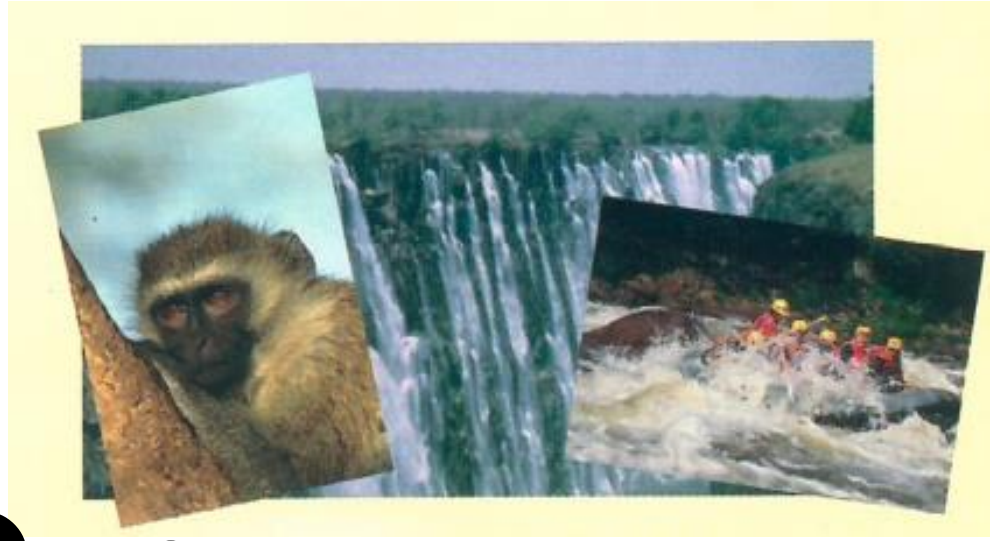
Click on the numbers for the answers.



Are you bored with your usual holidays? Why not try something different? A visit to Victoria Falls National Park in South Africa will give you the change you need.

1 c. It's a dream come true! The park is dominated by 190 square kilometres of dense rainforest. Take a stroll and see some of Africa's most typical wildlife, including leopards, baboons, monkeys and crocodiles, just to name a few.

2 b. One of the park's major attractions are the Victoria Falls on the Zambesi River. Hardly anyone would be left unimpressed by the breathtaking views and the deafening crash of the water. Being one of the world's largest waterfalls, it's a sight not to be missed.

3 e. Whitewater rafting, bungee jumping and canoeing are just some of the hair-raising experiences available to thrill-seeking visitors. For the not-so-adventurous, the cruises on the Zambesi, horse safaris and canoe safaris will prove equally fulfilling.

So, if you feel you need to escape from your usual holidays, don't put it off any longer. Book your adventure holiday to Victoria Falls National Park and you won't be disappointed.

c. Imagine this - a park located in a magnificent natural setting.

a. Explore Africa's rainforests.

d. There are lots of ways you can enjoy nature.

b. However, that is not all you can see in the park.

e. Apart from sightseeing, though, there are many outdoor activities you can try.

Answer these questions.

a. What do you think the purpose of the first sentence is in each paragraph?
To indicate what the rest of the paragraph is about.

b. Which of the following headlines do you think is the most suitable for the article? Why?

1 *A holiday in Africa that's suitable for everyone*

2 *Work out while on safari!*

3 *Time for an African adventure!*

1) is not suitable because the text did not mention families. It's also a bit boring.

2) only describes the more energetic activities described in paragraph 4. Paragraph 2 and 3 are about sightseeing, and there is certainly nothing remotely energetic about *taking a stroll*, which means a slow leisurely walk.

3) is the most suitable because it grabs the reader's attention and best describes the text.

Click on a. for the answer to a.
Click on the numbers for the answers to b.

Glossary

sightseeing seeing the *sights* the interesting things and places that can be seen. E.g. Big Ben, Tower Bridge, Buckingham Palace. You can't go inside. You look from outside.

stroll a slow leisurely walk.

safari an expedition to observe or hunt animals in their natural habitat.

excursion a short journey or trip for pleasure, especially one a short distance away from the main place you are visiting.

baboon

Bungee jumping

PLAN

An article is usually written for a newspaper or magazine. There are many different types of articles: news reports (articles giving news or information), articles discussing issues (for-against) or stating opinions, making suggestions etc. This unit deals with articles describing places. They are written for magazines or travel brochures. The aim of this article is to convince the reader to visit the place. Below is a plan of an article of this type, with questions to help you when planning one. Read the plan and compare it to the sample.

Actually, this is only a guide to planning. Your plan will answer these questions.

Headline	• write an interesting headline	
Introduction	• give general information about the place you are going to describe (name, location etc.) • give reasons for choosing the place	How can you make the introduction interesting? What place are you going to describe? Where is it located? What makes the place interesting/special?
Main part (2-3 paragraphs)	• describe the place (size, landscape, buildings, streets, transport, sights, facilities, people, lifestyle etc.) • discuss what activities people can do there	What is the place like? What are the important features of this place? Are there any sights worth visiting? What sort of facilities (e.g. hotels, shops) can be found there? What are the local people like? What can people do there to entertain themselves? What is the atmosphere of the place?
Conclusion	• make a general statement to sum up your ideas • make recommendations	What is your overall opinion about the place? Would you recommend it?

GUIDE TO WRITING

- Write an original headline to attract the readers' interest. The headline should be short and it can be in the form of an exciting word or phrase (Get ready for fun!), a summary of the article (A trip to Paris), a question (Would you go?) or a surprising fact (Two million holidaymakers a year!).
- Write about a place you are familiar with. Before you start, try to come up with ideas and plan what you are going to write.
- Choose a few of the most interesting ideas and expand on them. Don't include too many details otherwise you will exceed the word limit.
- Use an appropriate style when writing. Articles can be formal or informal. The aim of this article, however, is to convince the reader to visit the place you are describing. In order to achieve this it is easier to write in an informal, talkative style. Make your article sound lively and address the reader directly using the personal pronoun "you".

- Write an interesting introduction that will catch the readers' attention and make them want to continue reading.
- Use a topic sentence at the beginning of each paragraph. This sentence introduces the theme of the paragraph. The rest of the sentences in the paragraph develop the idea of the topic sentence. All the topic sentences should give the reader a rough summary of the article.
- Use a variety of techniques to make the article lively and interesting. Some of these techniques are: asking direct questions, using exclamation marks, using a large variety of vocabulary (phrases and expressions).
- Include a variety of structures, such as Conditionals, Participles, the Imperative etc.
- Use linking words/phrases to make the article flow.

WRITING PRACTICE

1 In the box below there are expressions you can use in articles for travel brochures or magazines. Complete the sentences using these expressions. There are two extra expressions which you do not need to use.

If you just want	Something worth visiting is	People interested in	By day, explore	Whether you go
Once discovered	For those who enjoy	Set in	Built on	Make time to

a. Make time to _____ visit the ancient ruins just a mile from the town.

b. Once discovered _____, you'll want to visit again and again.

c. For those who enjoy _____ living on the edge, this holiday place is a must.

d. Set in _____ the mountains, the hotel offers tranquility and privacy.

e. Whether you go _____ during the winter or the summer, the views are spectacular.

f. By day explore _____ the tiny medieval streets and outdoor cafés.

g. Something worth visiting is _____ the Royal Theatre, built in 1928.

h. If you just want _____ to soak up some sun, then why not go to Tunisia?

2 a. Read the rubric below and the introduction of the article on the next page. Why is the introduction unsuitable? Write a more suitable introduction for this article in the space provided. Look at the GUIDE TO WRITING for ideas.

A magazine for young people is investigating the topic:
Great places to go on holiday.
Write a short article for this magazine. (120-180 words)

VISIT BUDAPEST

Budapest is one of the most beautiful capital cities in the world. It is built on the river Danube. Lots of tourists visit Budapest every year.

What can you discover in Budapest?

Is Budapest one of the best cities in Europe? I think so! It's one of the most charming cities in the world. Built on the Danube, Budapest is one of the most beautiful and famous cities for tourists in the world.

b. Read the main part of the article and write topic sentences for each paragraph.

Make time to visit the old town. A walk down Budapest's tree-lined boulevards and a visit to Vörösmarty Square with its open-air cafés will definitely give you the opportunity to experience the charm and hospitality of the city. The shops in Budapest sell some of the most beautiful handmade crafts and antiques you'll ever see in the world.

A little further from the old town, you'll find some of Budapest's most famous sights. Visiting the Opera House and Parliament building, which overlooks the river Danube, is a must. Also, the Royal Palace must not be missed. To enjoy the majestic view of the city from the palace is as easy as a cable car ride.

But don't just stick to the main sights; Budapest also offers some enjoyable excursions a bit further out. One such excursion could be to Margaret Island. This is a small sanctuary with historical ruins, located in the Danube. Don't take your car there, though, because only bicycles and horse-drawn carriages are permitted.

c. **Now write a conclusion for the above article.**

It's truly remarkable what this city has to offer for all kinds of travellers. I've had many good memories of Budapest and hope to have many more, so go and visit. You won't be disappointed.

3 Task for homework

A local English language newspaper is going to publish articles about places worth visiting in your country. Write an article to be published in this newspaper. (120-180 words)

Your country may refer to the UK or your country of origin depending on your preference. If you want the extra practice, you could of course do one of each.